

The Truth about



Advertising is glutted, hype is unprecedented, most potential users have heard something or the other and Microsoft, after a long time, is smiling. XP is out and it is the best OS released by the Redmond Goliath since 1995. Is it worth your hard-earned money?

All of us have our own vision of the perfect operating system, something that understands us. What is it that we would wish for? Stability? A more secure environment? A slicker, friendlier interface, something that Mac users have been enjoying for years? What else? Windows XP, Microsoft's latest OS in the market, has all this and more. Enter the friendlier age of computing.

Operating systems of the future are going to be crash proof, we know that, perhaps even more reliable than the refrigerator. Same is the case with security. They will anticipate your needs, shape themselves according to your working habits—basically, help you work better.

XP, in this regard, is the first operating system in the market reflecting this change. It is going to pave the way for trends and technologies that will shape the operating systems of tomorrow.

Microsoft has studiously crafted XP to give you an open, expansive feel. It is clear that the software giant has spared neither money nor effort this time.

The versions

XP comes in two versions, XP Home and XP Professional. The differences between these two are clearly demarcated. In a nutshell, the Professional version of XP is for those who place more value on security, networking ability and multi-processor support. In a Home edition, you get pretty much everything too—multimedia, networking, firewall protection, the works. The Home edition is meant for individuals; small businesses can even set up a network using this cheaper edition, but without the high-end tools which only the Professional edition boasts.

The Pro

The Professional edition is expensive; it does all that the Home edition does and more, but with more élan. Using this edition, your network is scalable, much more secure than before, and handles like it never has.

Remember the Qualcomm CEO who lost his laptop and all valuable company data along with it? XP wasn't there that time, otherwise he could have used the Encrypting File System to scramble

sensitive data and keep his company's trade secrets the way they were meant to be: secrets.

Everything remote

Corporate networking ability and management is unique to XP Professional. It's roaming user profile lets users access documents located on their own PC from any computer on the network. Two very nifty tools that do not figure in XP Home are Remote Assistance and Remote Desktop. If you're stuck and help isn't locally available, your friend or a tech support person can connect directly to your PC over the Internet to fix it.

Similar to pcAnywhere (software that allows remote access), Remote Desktop provides a remote control service that allows corporate workers to log in from a remote computer over the Internet. Once logged in, the user can take full control of his computer as if he were right there in front of it. Though you must have XP Professional installed in the PC you wish to access, the remote clients (the computers you are connecting from) need to have Windows 95 or later versions